

Tree Report

Arboricultural Impact Assessment

For: Mr Fairclough

Site:

Land at: 3 Brickfield Cottages
East Cowes Road
East Cowes
Isle of Wight
PO32 6NH

Prepared by:

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Dip Arb L6 (ABC) MICFor MArborA

Date: 08 September 2025

Reference: WIT-25-14-009-aia

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Summary

I have been instructed in writing by Mr Fairclough to carry out a 'Development Site Tree Survey' at land adjacent to 3 Brickfield Cottages, East Cowes Road, East Cowes, Isle of Wight and prepare a report to accompany a planning application.

I visited the site on the 12th of August 2025. The site consists of a domestic garden separated of from, and formerly part of No 3 Brickfield Cottages. There is an existing garage and a static mobile home currently on the site, with associated access driveway. There are mature trees on and adjacent to the site.

In simple terms the proposal is to construct a modest dwelling on the site, approximately in the position of an existing planning consent. This proposal seeks to replace the existing garage, in the same position. I have reviewed the plans of the development, with the tree information and formed my opinion as to the arboricultural impacts. I have based my opinion on my site observations, information provided, and my experience as an arboriculturist.

I have concluded that, in my opinion, the proposed development will not have a detrimental impact on the trees on the site, that will influence the present or future amenity of the site or the surrounding area, provided the recommendations of this report are followed.

I have recommended that the prepared Tree Protection Plan is sufficient to provide protection to the trees on the site. As there are no works to be carried out within any Construction Exclusion Zone there is no requirement for an Arboricultural Method Statement.

1 INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 **Instruction:** I have been instructed in writing by Mr Fairclough to carry out a 'Development Site Tree Survey' at land adjacent to 3 Brickfield Cottages, East Cowes Road, East Cowes, Isle of Wight and prepare a report to accompany a planning application. The purpose of the report is to assess the impacts of proposed development works to trees on the site, and to provide information for the architectural design team regarding tree related constraints, and to aid successful integration of trees and development.
- 1.2 **The report includes:**
- A tree survey schedule
 - Tree survey plans: Site as Existing and Site as Proposed
 - An Arboricultural Impact Assessment
 - A Tree Protection Plan
- 1.3 **Scope and limitations:** The 'Development Site Tree Survey' provides data as required by BS5837:2012. Only the trees that are within the scope of the proposed works have been surveyed. It must not be considered a tree risk or safety assessment. Trees should be checked regularly, ideally on an annual basis, and for the purpose of this report I have assumed that this will be the case. If further urgent inspection is required, this will be noted in the recommendations.
- 1.4 **Statutory protection:** I accessed the Isle of Wight Council's website on the 17th of August 2025 and found that; no statutory tree protection is shown covering the trees in this report.
- 1.5 **The development:** In simple terms the proposal is to construct a modest dwelling on the site, approximately in the position of an existing planning consent. This proposal seeks to replace the existing garage, in the same position.
- 1.6 **Documents I have seen:** I have been provided with the site layout plans for the proposal.
- 1.7 **Qualifications and Experience:** I am a Chartered Arboriculturist and a Registered Consultant of the Arboricultural Association with experience and qualifications in arboriculture and have included a summary at Appendix 1.
- 1.8 **My opinion:** I have reviewed the plans of the development, with the tree information and formed my opinion as to the arboricultural impacts. I have based my opinion on my site observations, information provided, and my experience as an arboriculturist. I have summarised my opinion relating to each point at the end of each paragraph, with suggested solutions where appropriate, and underlined it for easy reference.

2 SITE VISIT AND OBSERVATIONS

- 2.1 **Site visit:** I visited the site on the 12th of August 2025. I was given permission to access the property by Mr Fairclough.
- 2.2 **Site location and description:** The site consists of a domestic garden separated of from, and formerly part of No 3 Brickfield Cottages. There is an existing garage and a static mobile home currently on the site, with associated access driveway. There are mature trees on and adjacent to the site.



Picture 1: A view across the site looking roughly southeast.

- 2.3 I took photographs of the site, and I have included a selection within this report, and at Appendix 3.
- 2.4 **Data collection:** My survey was conducted from ground level only without detailed investigations. Unless stated otherwise stem diameters were measured with a diameter tape and tree heights were estimated. Crown spreads were established by measuring accessible dimensions and estimating those less accessible by comparison. I only collected data relevant to the purpose of the report.
- 2.5 **Calculation of Root Protection Areas RPAs:** I have calculated the minimum area for root protection in accordance with BS5837:2012 Annex D. I have allocated the RPAs using my arboricultural experience to evaluate the most favourable location for this, given the environmental and ground conditions around any particular tree. This can often deviate from an exact circular form.

- 2.6 **Site survey plan:** The plan Ref: WIT-25-14-002-SUE, included at Appendix 5, shows a plan of the existing site and tree positions.
- 2.7 **Summary of tree data:** Table 1 shows a summary of the tree data, with a full schedule included at Appendix 4.

Table 1	Tree Retention Categories				Total
	Category A	Category B	Category C	Category U	
Trees surveyed	--	10	2	1	13
Groups surveyed	--	1	--	--	1
Hedges surveyed	--	--	--	--	--
Trees to be removed	--	--	2	1	3
Groups to be removed	--	--	--	--	--
Hedges to be Removed	--	--	--	--	--
Trees or groups requiring special precautions. (Additional Method Statement)	--	--	--	--	--

3 ARBORICULTURAL IMPACT ASSESSMENT

- 3.1 **Amenity:** The site has several semi-mature and mature trees which provide a contribution to the amenity of the surrounding area. The proposal has been carefully designed so that these trees can be retained as part of the development. Three BS category 'C' trees will be removed, but these are small and internal to site and cannot easily be seen from outside. For this reason, it is my opinion that there will be very little impact in terms amenity provided by trees either within the site or the surrounding area.
- 3.2 **Design, and the construction process:** The site has been laid out to include sufficient separation between retained trees, dwellings and infrastructure. The dwelling has been positioned considering the current existing planning consent. The proposed garage has been positioned over the concrete base of the existing garage, and could utilise a piling system should a new foundation be required.
- 3.3 Because of this separation, construction work can be segregated from the good quality trees and potential impacts to trees avoided, by using Tree Protection Fencing.
- 3.4 A Tree Protection Plan (TPP) has been prepared and appended to this report which sets out the measures required to provide physical protection for trees from construction works. If the prepared Tree Protection Plan is adhered to, throughout the works, then the impact to trees will be low.
- 3.5 **Post development pressure:** Pressure to remove trees sometimes follows development, but this is usually due to the trees not being considered at the design stage. Pressure can result from shading by trees, inconvenience of leaves in gutters or fear that trees will damage foundations and can result in the loss of important trees.
- 3.6 All these points have all been addressed at the design stage of this project. Some future pruning may become necessary, but this would be no more than would be required if the consented dwelling were built, or if the space remained as garden. In my opinion this development should not increase the likelihood of the future loss of the retained trees any more than the extant consent.

4 CONCLUSION

- 4.1 In my opinion, the proposed development will not have a detrimental impact on the trees on the site, that will influence the present or future amenity of the site or the surrounding area, provided the recommendations of this report are followed.
- 4.2 The prepared Tree Protection Plan is sufficient to provide protection to the trees on the site. As there are no works to be carried out within any Construction Exclusion Zone there is no requirement for an Arboricultural Method Statement.

5 RECOMMENDATIONS

- 5.1 Before any work starts on site, The Tree Protection Plan (TPP) Ref: WIT-25-14-005-TPP appended to this report, should be submitted to the Local Planning Authority (LPA) for approval. This should then be adhered to by all site personnel and be enforced by the LPA. This TPP includes the positions and the design of physical protection methods, that will protect the trees from the construction process.



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Chartered Arboriculturist
Arboricultural Association Registered Consultant

Date: 08 September 2025

Appendix 1 Qualifications and Experience

1. **Formal qualifications:** I hold the ABC Level 6 Diploma in Arboriculture, the ABC Level 3 Technicians Certificate in Arboriculture, and the Certificate in Arboriculture of the Royal Forestry Society. I was awarded the Lockhart Garrett trophy in 2016, for arboricultural excellence to the outstanding student.
2. **Practical experience:** After practical training in arboriculture, I worked for a local firm as an arborist. In 1999 I set up my own tree work contracting business and continued developing this for fifteen years until 2014. In 2014 I finished contracting to focus full time on consultancy.
3. **Professional experience:** I have been dealing with tree assessment throughout my arboricultural career, advising clients as part of my contracting business. In 2011, I attended and passed the LANTRA Professional Tree Inspection course, which is the premier tree inspection accreditation scheme in the UK. I was also an external consultant to Hampshire County Council advising on tree safety from 2015 – 2016. In 2017 I passed the International Society of Arboriculture Tree Risk Assessment Qualification.
4. **Continuing professional development:** It is important to keep up to date with new research and legislation. A summary of continuing professional development events that I have attended are listed below.

Date	Event Summary
16/4/25	CAVAT Tree Valuation Training
9-10/9/24	AA Annual Conference Warwick University
11/6/24 9/7/24 11/9/24	ICF Online training – Trees on Farms and Agroforestry.
4/6/24	AARC Standards and Training Day
12/2/24	AA Webinar Ancient Trees and Planning
23/1/24	BNG AA Webinar
7/11/23	LTOA Tree Officer Conference
10-11/11/23	QTRA Tree Risk Assessment Training
11-12/9/23	AA Annual Conference Warwick University
6/6/23	AARC Standards and Training Day
20/2/23	AARC Training Day – Subsidence Investigation
8/2/23	AA Webinar – Trees and the Law
1/2/23	AA Webinar - Trees and Planning
4-6/9/22	AA Annual Conference Loughborough

Date	Event Summary
7/6/22	AARC Standards and Development Day
23/5/22	ISA TRAQ Update course
16-19/11/21	Bats and Arboriculture Course – Bat Conservation Trust
16/6/21	AA webinar on Air Pollution
8/6/21	AARC Professional Standards Day
27/5/2021	Professional Tree Inspection Refresher
April 2021	Fungi Symposium Seminar Series
18/2/21	Tree Valuation
28/10/20	Subsidence Refresher Training - Bordon
6/11/19	National Tree Officer Conference: Reading
29/10/19	Micro-Drill Refresher Training
6/7/19	AA: Thinking Arbs Day
20/6/19	CAVAT Training: Tree Valuation
30/4/19	Future proofing Business Through Uncertain Times
16/3/19	A Branch Workshop: Fruit Tree Pruning
9/11/18	ICF: Planning and Development in Existing Woodland
6/11/18	National Tree Officers Conference
10-12/9/18	Arboricultural Association 52 nd National Amenity Conference
7/7/18	The Hollow Tree – Arboriculture. Veteran Tree Seminar
25/5/18	ICF Conifer Masterclass; Dan Luscombe & Tony Kirkham
13/4/18	ICF & RTPI Seminar: Trees in The Planning Process
30/1/18	Lantra Mortgage Report Writing Course
24-10-17	Technical Updates Tom Smiley and Dr Glyn Percival
21-23/10/17	ISA Tree Risk Assessment Qualification (TRAQ)
8/9/17	TREE RISK: What's the Likelihood of failure
11/7/17	Valuing and managing Veteran Trees
11/5/17	ICF Technology Workshop
27/10/16	Tree Protection and Planning
22/10/16	AA Visual Tree Assessment Workshop
6-7/9/16	Arboricultural Association's 50th National Amenity Conference
1/9/16	Assessment of Tree Forks; Dr Duncan Slater
20/4/16	AA: Subsidence Investigation Workshop (Advanced)
10/3/16	BS5837 Day 2: Managing Trees on Construction Sites

Date	Event Summary
9/3/16	AA BS5837 Day 1: Tree Assessment for Planning Applications
18/11/15	AA Tree Science Day: Fungi in the Life and Death of a Tree
20-23/9/15	Arboricultural Association's 49th National Amenity Conference
17/6/15	'Big Barn' Conference at Barcham Trees Ely
21/10/14	Subsidence Forum Training Day
14-17/9/14	Arboricultural Association's 48th National Amenity Conference
8-11/9/13	Arboricultural Association's 47th National Amenity Conference
16/4/13	Subsidence Investigation Workshop
10/4/13	AA Seminar Pests and Diseases Workshop
22/11/12	Trees in the Townscape Seminar
2-5/9/12	Arboricultural Association's 46 th National Amenity Conference
2/5/12	AA Seminar 2012 Tree preservation order regulations
	AA seminar BS 5837 2012
23-24/4/12	The Profession and Business of Consultancy
6-8/9/11	LANTRA Professional Tree Inspection
5/5/11	Mortgage report writing
4/5/11	BS 5837 2005 Workshop

Appendix 2 Level of Impact Explanatory Notes

Level of Impact		
The impact of the development on the trees health and amenity has been assessed and quantified using this table.		
Level of Impact	Health and Structure	Amenity
Severe	Very likely to cause death or structural failure. Tree unlikely to recover to good condition.	Likely to destroy or remove all aesthetic value of a tree or lead to loss of all aesthetic value of a tree.
Significant	Likely to induce or accelerate decline in health or stability of a tree. Recovery dependant on other factors such as vitality, age condition and environmental circumstances.	Would make a noticeable detriment on the aesthetic value of a tree or trees. The lost qualities, shape form or size unlikely to recover.
Moderate	Temporary loss of vitality or stability. A tree with high tolerance to damage or good vitality likely to recover, with no lasting detriment.	Temporary or transitional loss of amenity that will recover. E.g. the loss of small or low-quality trees that can be replaced; or retrenchment pruning that will result in long term gain for short term loss.
Minor	Within a tree's natural capability and vitality to suffer the impact with no permanent detriment to its health or stability.	Any loss of shape or visual beauty will not detract from a tree's overall visual merits, or the merits of the surrounding area.

Appendix 3 Photographs



Picture 2: Looking towards the southeast corner of the site.



Picture 3: looking southwest towards the existing garage.



Picture 4: Looking south at the gap between the garage and tree T5.



Picture 5: Looking westerly towards the road and trees T1 -T4.

Development Site Tree Survey Schedule

Survey date	Survey Reference	Survey Plan Ref	Site	Surveyor
12 August 2025	WIT-24-14-008-sch	WIT-25-14-002-SUE	Land adjacent to 3 Brickfield Cottages, East Cowes Road, East Cowes, Isle of Wight, PO32 6NH	Wayne Isaacson

Prefix	Feature	Retention Category				Total
		A	B	C	U	
T	Tree	0	10	2	1	13
G	Group	0	1	0	0	1
H	Hedge	0	0	0	0	0
A	Area	0	0	0	0	0
W	Woodland	0	0	0	0	0
S	Stump	0	0	0	0	0

Reference No	Species	Height (m)	Stem dia (mm)	Radial Crown Spread	Crown Clearance (m)	Lowest Branch	Life Stage	Condition (P)	Condition (S)	Estimated remaining contribution	Comments	Retention Category	RPA
T001	Pedunculate oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	12	350	N:4 E:2.5 S:2.5 W:4	3	4(N)	Semi Mature	Fair	Good			B	Radius: 4.2m. Area: 55 m ²
T002	Pedunculate oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	13	390	N:4.5 E:4.5 S:3 W:3	2	4(N)	Semi Mature	Good	Good	40+	Excavations in rooting area – recent.	B	Radius: 4.7m. Area: 69 m ²
T003	Pedunculate oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	15	420	N:4.5 E:4.5 S:4.5 W:4.5	3	4(mu)	Semi Mature	Fair	Good	40+	Excavations in rooting area – recent.	B	Radius: 5.0m. Area: 79 m ²

Reference No	Species	Height (m)	Stem dia (mm)	Radial Crown Spread	Crown Clearance (m)	Lowest Branch	Life Stage	Condition (P)	Condition (S)	Estimated remaining contribution	Comments	Retention Category	RPA
T004	Pedunculate oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	12	470	N:8 E:0.5 S:8 W:8	4	4(W)	Semi Mature	Good	Good	40+	Excavations in rooting area – recent.	B	Radius: 5.6m. Area: 99 m²
T005	Pedunculate oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	16	550	N:4.5 E:8 S:6 W:8	2.5	5(mu)	Semi Mature	Good	Fair	40+		B	Radius: 6.6m. Area: 137 m²
T006	Leyland cypress (<i>X Cuprocyparis leylandii</i>)	10	330	N:2 E:4 S:4 W:2	3	2(E)	Semi Mature	Good	Good	40+		B	Radius: 4.0m. Area: 50 m²
G007	Mixed species x100 (<i>Mixed species</i>)	8	150	N:3 E:3 S:3 W:3	1.5	0.5(mu)	Semi Mature	Fair	Fair	40+	Mixed species including hawthorn, blackthorn, lawson cypress, ash, and elm. Group forming hedgeline screen.	B	Area: 85 m²
T008	Common ash (<i>Fraxinus excelsior</i>)	8	200	N:5 E:5 S:1 W:5	2	2(W)	Semi Mature	Fair	Fair	20+	No significant signs or symptoms of ash dieback disease.	B	Radius: 2.4m. Area: 18 m²
T009	Pedunculate oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	18	900#	N:8 E:8 S:8 W:8	3	4(mu)	Early Mature	Good	Good		All dimensions estimated, with assessment from distance as access restricted. Off-site tree.	B	Radius: 10.8m. Area: 366 m²
T010	Dogwood (<i>Cornus sp.</i>)	4	30	N:2 E:2 S:2 W:2	1.5	0.5(mu)	Semi Mature	Fair	Good	10+	Not a tree but included for completeness.	C	Radius: 1.6m. Area: 8 m²
T011	Cultivar apple (<i>Malus domestica</i>)	4	60, 50, 50	N:2 E:2 S:2 W:2	0.5	1(mu)	Young	Good	Good	40+		C	Radius: 1.1m. Area: 4 m²

Reference No	Species	Height (m)	Stem dia (mm)	Radial Crown Spread	Crown Clearance (m)	Lowest Branch	Life Stage	Condition (P)	Condition (S)	Estimated remaining contribution	Comments	Retention Category	RPA
T012	Pittosporum (<i>Pittosporum sp.</i>)	4.5	100	N:1.5 E:1.5 S:1.5 W:1.5	1.5	1(mu)	Young	Poor	Fair	<5	Tree in irreversible decline.	U	Radius: 1.2m. Area: 5 m ²
T013	Horse chestnut (<i>Aesculus hippocastanum</i>)	13	480	N:6 E:6 S:6 W:6	0.5	2(E)	Semi Mature	Good	Good	40+	Infection of horse chestnut leaf blotch (<i>Guignardia aesculi</i>) and horse chestnut leaf miner (<i>Cameraria ohridella</i>) on the leaves.	B	Radius: 5.8m. Area: 106 m ²
T014	Pedunculate oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	15	700	N:8 E:10 S:10 W:10	3	4(S)	Early Mature	Good	Good	40+	Crown lifted over roadway.	B	Radius: 8.4m. Area: 222 m ²

KEY TO SURVEY SCHEDULE		
Reference number	Each tree or group is allocated a reference number, and a metal tag with this number may be attached to the specific tree or in the case of a group one tree within the group. This is to aid accurate identification of each tree either for work instructions or record keeping.	
Species	Each tree should be identified by its scientific name. In some cases, this may not be possible in the field, because the features required for accurate identification may not be present at the time of the survey. As the plans and reports will need to be used by non arboricultural professions, common names are included.	
Height	Tree height is estimated and recorded in metres.	
Stem diameter	Trunk/stem diameters are measured at 1.5m from the ground. These are rounded to the nearest 10mm. Where easy measurement is not possible (for example, for multi stemmed or densely branched trees, and for off-site trees) then stem diameter is estimated. For groups and hedges this will be a representative average.	
Radial Crown Spread	An estimation is made, to the nearest half metre, to give the average radius of the tree canopy. Cardinal points are used where the canopy is significantly uneven. For groups, this is a value representative of most trees or an average within the group. For hedges the crown radius is an estimate of half the width of the hedge.	
Crown clearance	The distance between the ground and the lowest part of the existing canopy. Given in metres.	
Lowest Branch	The distance from the ground, in metres to the first <u>significant</u> branch. The direction is also given where this appears important. The symbol (mu) is used where multiple branches occur from a common union.	
Estimated remaining contribution	The remaining useful life is given as one of four categories, <10, 10+, 20+ or 40+. These are all given in years. This is the time the tree is expected to provide useful amenity in its situation, rather than its absolute longevity.	
Comments	Where there are notable defects or conditions, or points of interest these will be recorded under this heading. Unless required for urgent safety reasons, this will not include work recommendations as this is not part of the instructions.	
Item	Category	Description
Condition Physiological (P)	Good	Appears to be healthy and have good vitality.
	Fair	Generally in good health but with visible signs of decline or reduced vitality.
	Poor	Obviously in poor health and significant decline.
	Dead/ Moribund	Dead, or very little live growth.
Condition Structural (S)	Good	No significant structural defects.
	Fair	Some visible defects but no significant hazards.
	Poor	Significant defects or dangerous /potentially dangerous condition.
	Hazardous	Requiring immediate attention to remove or reduce risk.

KEY TO SURVEY SCHEDULE		
Age class/ Life stage	Young	Trees less than 20 years old.
	Semi-mature	Trees still having strong apical growth, and or potential for significant, future increase in size.
	Early-mature	Tree entering a phase of stable growth with less significant size increase. Canopy starting to reduce apical dominance and vigour.
	Mature	Trees of normal life expectancy, reaching or having reached its probable ultimate canopy proportion. Maintaining a consistent, and not deteriorating, size and condition.
	Senescent	Trees beyond maturity, in natural retrenchment or decline, but not qualifying as Veteran or Ancient.
	Veteran	Trees that are of interest culturally, aesthetically or biologically because of their age, size or features, such as damage or decay; but not qualifying as ancient.
	Ancient	Has outstanding age for its species. Will also have features consistent with old age such as large girth, decay, and crown retrenchment.
Category	A	Trees of high quality, with an estimated remaining useful life of at least 40 years. Ancient and veteran trees.
	B	Trees of moderate quality. With a remaining useful life expectancy of at least 10 years.
	C	Trees of low quality. Likely to be removed within 10 years due to deteriorating health and/or condition; excessive nuisance to people; or for good arboricultural management. Trees that are too small to be important. Category 'C' trees are not considered to be a materiel constraint, but are of a suitable condition to be retained in the short term.
	U	Trees that are unsuitable for retention; due to irreversible decline, causing structural damage, or posing unacceptable risk.
RPA radius	The radius of a circle with the equivalent area of the RPA. Given in metres.	



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